

⑥ New & Improved

System 6 can read, write, and initialize disks in HFS (Macintosh) format as well as in ProDOS (Apple II) format if the HFS File System Translator is installed. System 6 can also read Apple DOS 3.3 and Apple Pascal 5.25' disks with the appropriate File System Translators installed, but it can't write or initialize disks in these formats (the FSTs are read-only)

To perform an initialize or erase operation, first click on the disk you want to erase, then pull down the Disk menu and select "Initialize..." or "Erase...". The dialog which appears (Figure 6G) allows you to specify the new name of the disk (the default entry for the disk name is the disk's current name, or "Untitled" if the disk is blank).

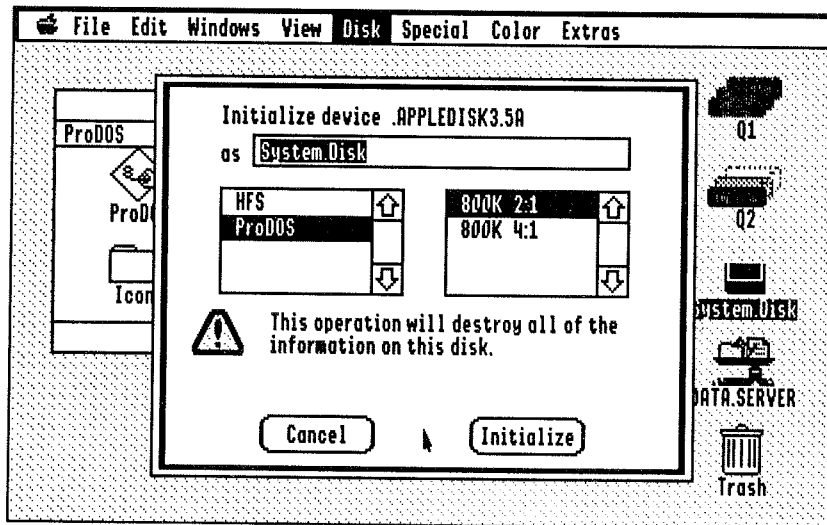


Figure 6G—Disk Initialization Dialog

If you're making a ProDOS disk, keep in mind that ProDOS disk names must begin with a letter and that they can be up to fifteen characters long and can include letters, digits, and periods. Macintosh disk names can be up to twenty-seven characters long and can contain any character except a colon. Don't choose a name that's already used by a disk on the Finder desktop.

Next, select the desired format of the new disk from the list on the left. If you're making a new 5.25" disk, your only choice is ProDOS, since the Macintosh does not support 5.25" disks. If you're using a 3.5" drive, and will be using the disk only on the IIGS, or if you will need to use it with older programs like AppleWorks, choose ProDOS. If you will be using the 3.5" disk to transfer files back and forth between the IIGS and the Macintosh, choose HFS.